
HS 557: Rural Development: Structures, Institutions and Processes

Course Code	HS 557
Course Name	Rural Development: Structures, Institutions and Processes
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	UG/PG/PhD
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	60th BoA (Jun 2025)

Preamble

This course explores village India and its social, political and economic life. Through the appreciation of significance of Village Studies, it traces how village India is discussed and explained and analyzed through an exploration of agrarian structure, political institutions and economy of the people. The institutions, largely Panchayati Raj Institutions, and decentralization of finances, authority, responsibility, it traces the aspects of democracy and democratic processes. The development of infrastructure, and provisions of basic services will be explored through State programs and policies and how over the period of last 75 years, the ambit of policies as well as the nature of governance transformed.

Course Modules

- **Unit 1: Knowing the rural India:** (6 lecture hours)
 - Colonial and orientalist ideas and village as mini republic
 - Idea of self-sufficient villages
 - Authentic India
 - Little Community
 - Rural and rurality
- **Unit 2: Village Studies:** (12 lecture hours)
 - 1950s and the emergence of tradition of Village Studies
 - Book-view and Field-view
 - Harmony, unity and reciprocity: exploring structure, organization and institutions
 - Caste and Social structure of village
 - Village and Patriarchy
 - Agrarian class structure
- **Unit 3: Political Economy and Institutions in Village India:** (6 lecture hours)
 - Panchayat and Panchayati Raj Institution
 - 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act and decentralization
 - Self-help Groups, Non-governmental organizations
 - New dimensions of politics and political life
- **Unit 4: Strategies of Rural Development:** (10 lecture hours)
 - Five-Year Plans and Shifts in rural development programs
 - Basic needs programs
 - Infrastructure programs

- Financial inclusion
- Convergence and Holistic development

• **Unit 5: Techniques and Methods of Assessment of Rural Development:** (8 lecture hours)

- Rapid Rural Appraisal
- Participatory Rural Appraisal
- Transact Analysis
- Emerging techniques

Laboratory Modules

NA

Text Books

1. Madan, Vandana (Ed.). (2002). *The Village in India*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.

References

1. Cohn, B.S. 1987. *An Anthropologist among Historians*. Delhi: Oxford University Press.
2. Srinivas, M.N. (Ed.). 1955. *India's Villages*. Bombay: Asia Publishing House.
3. Marriott, M. (Ed.). 1961. *Village India: Studies in the Little Community*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
4. Materials released by Ministry of Rural Development and National Institute of Rural Development and Panchayati Raj
5. Chambers, Robert. 1994. The Origins and Practice of Participatory Rural Appraisal. *World Development*. Vol. 22(7): 953-969